

May

5

Cinco de Mayo 1862

Following the French invasion of Mexico, Mexican troops defeated a far larger battalion of French soldiers at the Battle of Puebla. This triumph is still celebrated every fifth of May (*cinco de mayo*).

Born this day

1892 Dorothy Garrod, British archaeologist and professor. In 1939, she became the first woman to be made a professor at Cambridge University, UK.

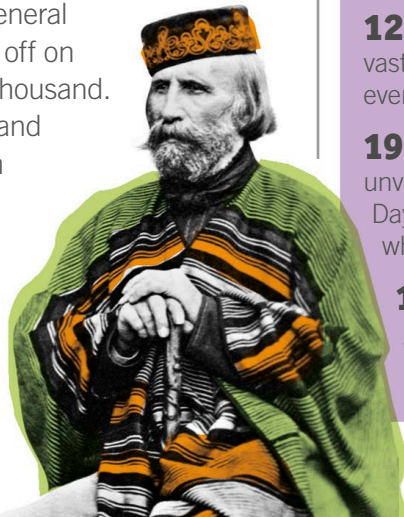
1988 Adele, British singer and songwriter. She became a global superstar after record-breaking sales of her first album, which showcased her remarkable voice.

1921 Perfume of choice

French fashion designer Coco Chanel released her bestselling Chanel No. 5 fragrance. This luxury scent combined 80 ingredients in a rectangular bottle.

1860 One Italy

Italian general Giuseppe Garibaldi set off on the Expedition of the Thousand. He sailed from Genoa and overthrew the Kingdom of the Two Sicilies in a key development that led towards the unification of Italy.



Also on this day

1260 Kublai Khan became ruler of the vast Mongol Empire in East Asia. He would eventually become emperor of China.

1958 The Children's Peace Monument was unveiled in Japan on the annual Children's Day to honour the many thousands of children who died in the Hiroshima tragedy of 1945.

1984 Itaipu Dam in South America began generating electricity. It was the world's largest hydroelectric dam until 2012.